FOR PARENTS · SUPPORTING YOUR YOUNG PLAYER

RESPECT THE COACH

Same team, same goal

05

THE QUICK VERSION

> Your child does best when the adults around them are on the same page. Backing the coach in front of your child, and raising any concerns calmly, later and privately, keeps their trust in the team and their focus where it belongs: on playing.

WHAT'S REALLY GOING ON

When a parent criticises the coach at home, or calls out different instructions from the sideline, kids get caught between two voices they love and respect. They hesitate, lose confidence and often stop listening to both of you. Respecting the coach just means choosing the right time and place to disagree.

The 24-hour rule

After a game, wait at least 24 hours before raising a concern with the coach. Emotions settle, you hear your child's side, and the conversation is calmer and far more useful for everyone.

HOW TO RAISE A CONCERN, THE RIGHT WAY

1. **Wait 24 hours.** Never in the heat of the moment or the car park.
2. **Ask your child first.** What do they think? Sometimes they're less worried than we are.
3. **Book a time.** A quick message: "Could we find 10 minutes this week for a chat?"
4. **Lead with curiosity.** "Can you help me understand..." opens doors. Accusations close them.
5. **Keep it about your child.** Their development, not comparisons with others.

TRY THIS

1 Cheer, don't coach
Leave tactical instructions to the coach. Your job is encouragement.

2 Back them at home
Even if you'd do it differently, keep that conversation between adults.

3 Help your child self-advocate
Older players can ask the coach themselves: "What can I work on?"

4 Say thank you
Most junior coaches are volunteers. A thank you goes a long way.

5 Safety is the exception
If it's about safety, wellbeing or inappropriate behaviour, don't wait. Contact the club's child safety or welfare officer straight away.

SAY THIS, NOT THAT

SAY THIS	NOT THAT
"What did coach ask you to work on?"	~~"Ignore the coach and just shoot."~~
"Let's ask coach how you can earn more minutes."	~~"Coach doesn't know what they're doing."~~
"Thanks for today, coach!"	~~(Complaining loudly in the car park)~~

QUICK SELF-CHECK

- [ ] I don't criticise the coach in front of my child
- [ ] I wait 24 hours before raising a concern
- [ ] I keep sideline comments to encouragement
- [ ] I know who the club's welfare officer is

Can't tick them all yet? That's normal. Pick one to work on this week.

COACH'S CORNER

> **Coaches don't need to be perfect. A child who sees the adults around them working together learns exactly how to be a great teammate.**

THE FUTURE BALLER TEAM